

Strange Evals

Why?

- ▶ Benchmark scores give a ten-thousand foot view of capability; this group is all about building more powerful and nuanced intuitions of capability

“Become one with the data.”

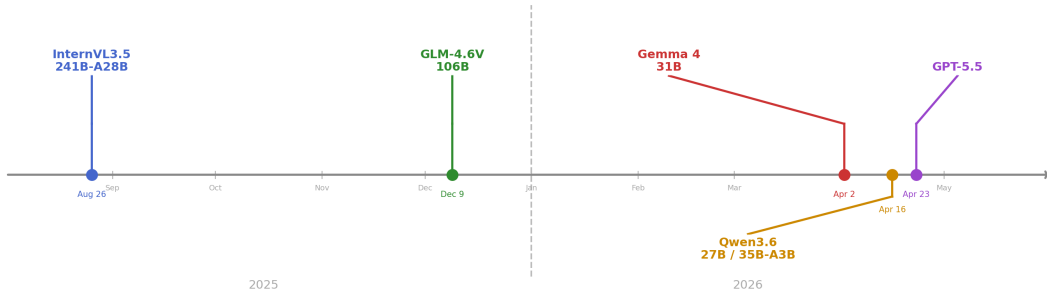
— Andrej Karpathy, “A Recipe for Training Neural Networks,” 2019 [10]

The State of VLM Benchmarks

“While large language models with vision capabilities (VLMs), e.g., GPT-4o and Gemini-1.5 Pro, score high on many vision-understanding benchmarks, they are still struggling with low-level vision tasks that are easy to humans.”

— Rahmanzadehgervi et al., “Vision Language Models Are Blind,” 2024 [9]

The VLMS



Benchmark Usage – Top 20

	MMU Pro	MMU	MathVisio	CharXiv	RefCOCO	MMStar	RealWorldQA	DynaMath	A2D	OCRBench	MVBench	MLVU	LVBench	VideoMMU	MMBench-dev	BLINK	MUJBENCH	Hallusion	ZeroBench	SimpleVQA
GPT-5.5	81.2	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Qwen3.6-35B-A3B	75.3	81.7	86.4	78.0	92.0	—	85.3	—	92.7	89.4	74.6	86.2	71.4	83.7	92.8	—	—	69.8	34.4	58.9
Gemma-4-31B	76.9	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
GLM-4.6V	66.0	76.0	85.2	63.2	88.6	75.9	—	54.5	88.8	86.5	—	—	59.5	74.7	—	65.5	77.1	—	25.8	—
InternVL3.5	—	77.7	82.7	48.3	92.4	77.9	75.2	46.5	87.3	907	76.5	78.2	67.1	—	—	61.4	47.5	57.3	—	—

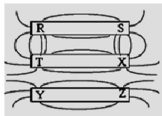
[4, 5, 6, 7, 8]

Example

The stated goal of MMMU, the most cited vision benchmark, is to understand how close a model is to performing at the same level as “skilled adults”.

[1]

MMMU Pro – 5 Random Examples



The diagram above depicts iron filings sprinkled around three permanent magnets. Pole R is the same pole as

- A) Y and Z
- B) X and T
- C) R and T
- D) X and Y
- E) T and Z
- F) T and Y
- G) R and Z
- H) R and Y
- I) X and Z



What is your opinion on the fact that certain large insects act as predators of pests? Are they allies or enemies in your view?

- A) Neutral; it doesn't affect the crops positively or negatively.
- B) Symbiotic; it has a mutual relationship with the crops.
- C) Vector; it is not a pest directly but spreads viruses which damage yield.
- D) Threat; it may not harm the crops directly, but its presence could attract other pests.
- E) Beneficial; it helps in biological control of pests.
- F) Neither; this large insect is not a problem, nor is it a beneficial.
- G) I don't know and don't want to guess.
- H) Friend; this is clearly a predator of pests.
- I) Foe; this is a pest of crops.
- J) Parasitic; it feeds on the pests but also harms the crops.



Refer to the figure, which term best describes the practice where members create the visual essence of a chapter on a three-foot strip of paper, discuss it, and then assemble the strips into the shape of sun rays?

- A) Chapter Ray
- B) Story Ray
- C) Narrative Ray
- D) Magical Realism Ray
- E) Plot Ray
- F) Animal Fantasy Ray
- G) Folklore Ray
- H) Trickster Tale Ray
- I) Fiction Ray
- J) Fable Ray

Birth Order	Number of children	Number of deaths from COVID
oldest child in family	10,479	755
second child	130,386	2,041
3rd or more children	1,617,163	1,195
4th or more children	42,919	279
every day	31,386	452
Total		

The overall Chi-square value was

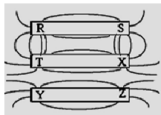
- A) 1196.29
- B) 1700.21
- C) 1300.54
- D) 1567.34
- E) 1082.76
- F) 1552.34
- G) 1203.82
- H) 1100.65
- I) 987.45
- J) 1356.98

Project	Beta	IRR
W	.80	9.4%
X	.95	10.9
Y	1.15	13.0
Z	1.45	14.2

An all-equity firm is considering the following projects: The T-bill rate is 3.5 percent, and the expected return on the market is 11 percent. Which projects would be incorrectly accepted or rejected if the firm's overall cost of capital was used as a hurdle rate?

- A) Project Z would be incorrectly rejected; Project Y would be incorrectly accepted.
- B) Project Z would be incorrectly accepted; Project X would be incorrectly rejected.
- C) Project X would be incorrectly rejected; Project Y would be incorrectly accepted.
- D) Project X would be incorrectly accepted; Project Y would be incorrectly rejected.
- E) No project would be incorrectly rejected; Project X would be incorrectly accepted.
- F) Project Y would be incorrectly rejected; Project X would be incorrectly accepted.
- G) No project would be incorrectly rejected; Project Z would be incorrectly accepted.
- H) Project X would be incorrectly rejected; Project Z would be incorrectly accepted.
- I) Project Y would be incorrectly rejected; Project Z would be incorrectly accepted.
- J) Project Z would be incorrectly rejected; Project X would be incorrectly accepted.

MMMU Pro – Answers



The diagram above depicts iron filings sprinkled around three permanent magnets. Pole R is the same pole as

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Birth date	Number of observers	Number of deaths from COVID
never out to eat	10,479	755
once a month	130,388	2041
2-3 times a month	140,143	1,075
4-5 times a month	42,919	279
every day	31,386	452
Total	338,015	4,502

The overall Chi-square value was

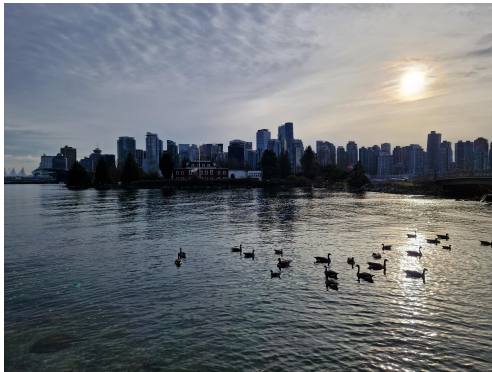
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- C) Project X would be incorrectly rejected; Project Y would be incorrectly accepted.
- D) Project X would be incorrectly accepted; Project Y would be incorrectly rejected.
- E) No project would be incorrectly rejected; Project X would be incorrectly accepted.
- F) Project Y would be incorrectly rejected; Project X would be incorrectly accepted.
- G) No project would be incorrectly rejected; Project Z would be incorrectly accepted.
- H) Project X would be incorrectly rejected; Project Z would be incorrectly accepted.**
- I) Project Y would be incorrectly rejected; Project Z would be incorrectly accepted.
- J) Project Z would be incorrectly rejected; Project X would be incorrectly accepted.

Cherry Picked ZeroBench Example

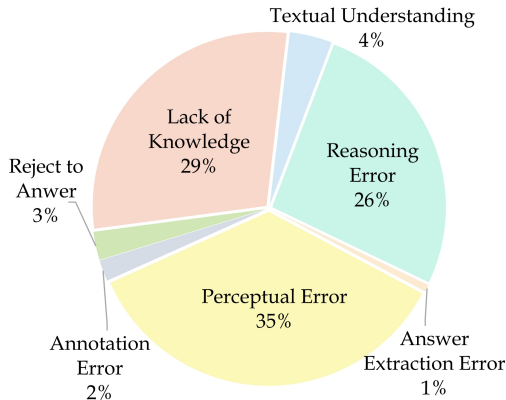


Question: What percentage of the geese are oriented such that their body faces south on an 8-point compass? Give your answer to one decimal place.

Comparing Benchmarks

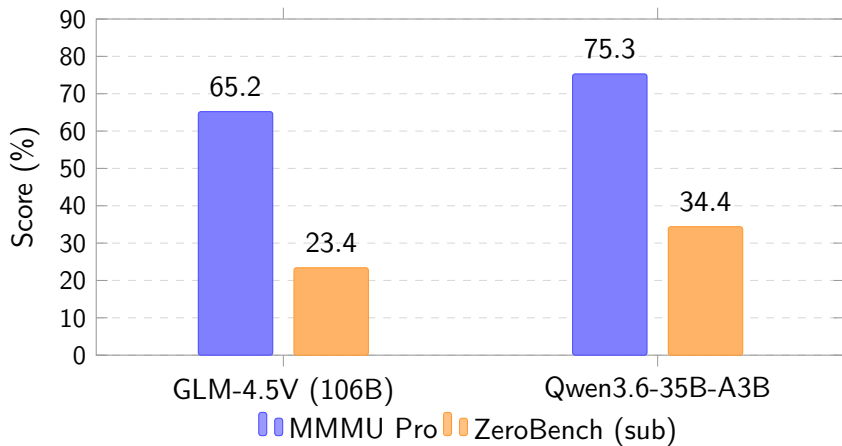
	General Knowledge	Visual Reasoning
MMMU Pro	High	Low
ZeroBench	Medium	High

MMMU Error Analysis (GPT-4V)



“We meticulously examine 150 randomly sampled error instances from GPT-4V’s predictions. These instances are analyzed by expert annotators who identify the root causes of mispredictions based on their knowledge and the golden explanations if available.”

MMMU Pro vs ZeroBench (Sub)



References

1. Yue et al., “MMMU: A Massive Multi-discipline Multimodal Understanding and Reasoning Benchmark for Expert AGI,” CVPR 2024.
2. Roberts et al., “ZeroBench: An Impossible Visual Benchmark for Contemporary Large Multimodal Models,” arXiv:2502.09696, 2025.
3. THU DM, “GLM-4.5V Technical Report,” 2025.
4. Qwen Team, “Qwen3.6-35B-A3B: Agentic Coding Power, Now Open to All,” 2026.
5. OpenAI, “Introducing GPT-5.5,” 2026.
6. Google DeepMind, “Gemma 4 Technical Report,” 2026.
7. THU DM, “GLM-4.6V Technical Report,” 2025.
8. OpenGVLab, “InternVL3.5 Technical Report,” 2025.
9. Rahmanzadehgervi et al., “Vision Language Models Are Blind,” arXiv:2407.06581, 2024.
10. Karpathy, “A Recipe for Training Neural Networks,” <https://karpathy.github.io/2019/04/25/recipe/>, 2019.

Appendix: Links

- ▶ Proof the sun-ray task actually exists with that phrasing